Cardiovascular course · week 5 of 8

Today's plan, Alex

01 **Review 14 cards** ✓
Spaced repetition · 5 min

02 **Pressure–volume loops**
Targeted set: preload vs. afterload missed on 2 of your last 6 items.

Begin · 6 cases Why this?

03 **New: Systolic murmurs**
Unlocks after 02 · 12 min

This course so far

All of Domain 1

Hypertension	72%
Dysrhythmias	48%
Ischemic heart disease	61%
Heart failure	35%
Valvular heart disease	12%
Adverse effects of drugs	28%

DOMAIN 01 · USMLE CONTENT OUTLINE

Medical Knowledge

18 systems

Strong Developing Needs review
Not yet studied

Outline order | Needs attention

Human Development — 1 TO REVIEW

Immune System — 1 TO REVIEW

Blood & Lymphoreticular — 2 TO REVIEW

Behavioral Health —

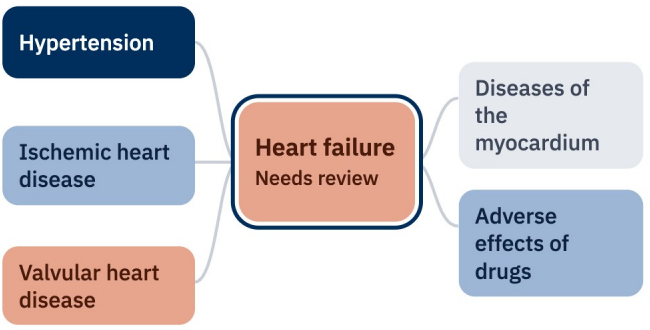
Nervous System & Special Senses —

Skin & Subcutaneous Tissue —

Musculoskeletal System —

Cardiovascular System — IN COURSE

Cardiovascular System 41%



Valvular disease is dragging this down. Practice →

Outline topics

Tap to re-center the map

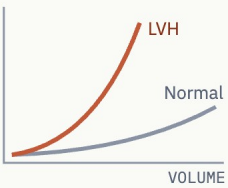
- Infectious, immunologic & inflammatory — STRONG
- Neoplasms — DEVELOPING
- Dysrhythmias — DEVELOPING
- **Heart failure** — FOCUS
- Ischemic heart disease — DEVELOPING
- Diseases of the myocardium — –
- Diseases of the pericardium — –
- Valvular heart disease — REVIEW

A 64-year-old man with long-standing hypertension has 3 months of exertional dyspnea and two-pillow orthopnea. An S4 is heard at the apex. Echo shows concentric LV hypertrophy.

BP	HR	EF
166/96	84	62%

Which change best explains his symptoms?

- A. Decreased myocardial contractility — YOURS
- **B. Decreased LV compliance — ANSWER**
- C. Increased LV end-systolic volume
- D. Left ventricular volume overload
- E. Reduced right ventricular preload



EDPVR

TEACHING POINT

A stiff ventricle needs more pressure to fill. Raised LVEDP backs into the lungs — HFpEF. EF is preserved, so contractility isn't the problem.

Ask a tutor

Next case

Synthesis · day 9 of 28

Where today's hours go

STEP 1 READINESS

Likely pass

84%

▲ from 71% last week



| Pass line Your likely range

From 1,240 answered items. Range narrows as you answer more; check it against your NBME practice exams. How this works

Highest yield today

YIELD

01 **Heart failure**
Cardiovascular · 45 min

02 **Acid–base disorders**
Renal & Urinary · 40 min

03 **Obstructive vs. restrictive disease**
Respiratory · 30 min

04 **Sensitivity, specificity & PPV**
Biostatistics · 20 min

Start today's block · 2 h Adjust

WHY THIS TODAY

Heart failure

Cardiovascular · 3 case sets · ~45 min

PROJECTED YIELD

Expected rise in your pass likelihood from this block

+2.4 pts

Exam weight

One of the most-tested topics in the cardiovascular outline.

Your gap

Estimated mastery 58%, target 80%. Missed 5 of your last 9 items.

Forgetting

Last practiced 11 days ago; predicted recall is slipping.

Leverage

Builds on valvular and ischemic disease; leads to cardiomyopathies and HF drugs.

Time to improve

About 45 minutes to reach target. Shorter is better.

Not today

Start heart failure

Your choices shape the plan, too.

AR

Competency record

10 DOMAINS

01 Medical Knowledge

Systems studied	Topics to review	Step 1 pace
6 / 18	11	On pace

DOMAIN		LEVEL
02	Patient Care Updated Oct 12	
03	Communication Updated Oct 9	
04	Professionalism Updated Sep 30	
05	Patient-based Learning & Improvement Updated Oct 2	
06	System-based Practice Updated Sep 18	
07	IPE, Teaching & Leadership Updated Oct 6	
08	Truth & Scientific Investigation Updated Oct 14	
09	Global Health & Humanitarian Work Updated Sep 22	
10	Spiritual Healing & Caregiving Updated Oct 1	